

Notes 7

cat

Definition

The cat command is used for displaying the content of a file cat is short for concatenate which is the comand's intended use.

Usage/Formula

- `cat + option +file(s) to display`

Examples

- `cat todo.lst`
- `cat ~/Documents/todo.lst`
- `cat -n ~/Documents/todo.md`
- `cat -b ~/Document/todo.md`

tac

Definition

The tac command is used for displaying the content of a file in reverse order just like cat tac concatenates files and displays the output of the concatenation

Usage/Formula

- `tac + option + file(s) to display`

examples

- `tac todo.md`
- `tac ~/Documents/todo.md`

head

Definition

the head command displays the top N number of lines of a given file. by default it prints the first 10 lines if more then one file name is provied then dta from each file is preceded by it's file name

Usage/Formula

- `head + option + file(s)`

examples

- `head ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`
- `head -5 ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`
- `head -n 1 *.csv *.py`

tail

Definition

the tail command displays the last N number of lines of a given file by default it prints the last 10 lines if more than one file name is provided then data from each file is preceded by its file name

Usage/Formula

- `tail + option + file`

examples

- `tail ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`
- `tail -5 ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`
- `tail -n 1 *.csv *.py`

cut

Definition

the cut command is used to extract a specific section of each line of a file and display it to the screen

Usage/Formula

- `cut + option + file(s)`

examples

- `cut -d ':' -f1 /etc/passwd`
- `cut -d ':' -f1,7 /etc/passwd`
- `cut -b 1-5 usernames.txt`

sort

Definition

the sort command is used for sorting files the sort command supports sorting alphabetically in reverse order by number and by month

Usage/Formula

- `sort + option + file`

examples

- `sort users.lst`
- `sort -o sorted.lst users.lst`
- `sort -r users.txt`

WC

Definition

the wc command is used for printing the number of lines characters and bytes in a file

Usage/Formula

- `wc + option + file(s)`

examples

- `wc -m users.txt`
- `wc -l users.txt`
- `wc -w users.txt`

tr

Definition

the tr command is used for translating or deleting characters from standard output

Usage/Formula

- `standard output | tr + option + set + set`

examples

- `cat file.txt | tr '.' ','`
- `cat program.py | tr "[:space:]" '\t'`
- `cat file.py | tr -s "[:space:]" ' '`

diff

Definition

the diff command compares files and displays the differences between them

Usage/Formula

- `diff + option + file1 + file2`

examples

- `diff cars.csv cars-backup.csv`
- `diff -y cars.csv cars-backup.csv`

grep

Definition

grep is used to search text in given file grep works line by line basis (it matches the search criteria in a line by line basis)

Usage/Formula

- `grep + option + search criteria + file(s)`

examples

- `grep 'dracula' ~/Documents/dracula.txt`
- `grep -i 'dracula' ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`
- `grep -in 'dracula' ~/Documents/Book/dracula.txt`